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Curriculum Vitae

AAMIR SOHAIL

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Education

2023 – 2027	**Ph.D. in Psychology** Thesis: *Social learning in humans and machines* Advisors: Dr. Lei Zhang & Prof. Patricia L. Lockwood	University of Birmingham Birmingham, UK
	Visiting Student Researcher Supervisors: Prof. Russell A. Poldrack & Prof. Robb Willer	Stanford University Stanford, USA
2017 – 2018	**M.Sc. in Brain Imaging (First-class honours)** Thesis advisors: Dr. Claudia Danielmeier & Dr. Jan Derrfuss	University of Nottingham Nottingham, UK
2013 – 2016	**B.Sc. in Biomedical Science (Upper second-class honours)** Thesis advisors: Prof. Anne R. Lingford-Hughes & Dr. Samuel P. Turton	Imperial College London London, UK

Employment

Dec 2023 – Mar 2026	**Post Graduate Teaching Assistant**, School of Psychology Line Manager: Dr. Steven Frisson	University of Birmingham Birmingham, UK
Jul 2024 – Sep 2025	**MR Scanner Operator**, Centre for Human Brain Health Line Manager: Dr. Nina Salman	University of Birmingham Birmingham, UK
Oct 2021 – Sep 2023	**CINN Operations Support**, School of Psychology and Clinical Language Sciences Line Manager: Prof. Anastasia Christakou	University of Reading Reading, UK
Apr 2021 – Oct 2021	**Junior Research Fellow**, School of Psychology and Clinical Language Sciences Line Manager: Prof. Anastasia Christakou	University of Reading Reading, UK

Awards & Grants

2025 **Google Cloud Research Credits Program** (**£150**), Google

2024 **Graduate Student Bursary for UK Ethnic Minority Groups** (**£300**), BACN
Nationally competitive (1 awarded per year)

European Forum Alpbach Scholarship (**£2,500**), Club Alpbach London
Internationally competitive (5% acceptance rate)

2023 **MRC AIM DTP Scholarship** (**£100,000**), MRC/University of Birmingham
Internationally competitive

LGBT+ Inclusion Initiative Fund (**£300**), University of Reading

Teaching

2023 – present **Magnetic Resonance Imaging in Cognitive Neuroscience** (graduate course)
University of Birmingham. Module convenor: Dr. Magdalena Chechlacz

Jan 2023 – Apr 2023 **Introduction to Neuroscience Methods** (undergraduate course)
University of Reading. Module convenor: Prof. Anastasia Christakou

Mentoring & Outreach

2024 – present **Student Mentor**, Social Mobility Foundation

STEM Ambassador, STEM Learning

Project Access Mentor, Project Access

2023 – present **OHBM Mentoring Program**, OHBM

Jul 2022 **in2STEM Project Lead**, in2Science

2022 – 2023 **CINN Work Experience Placements**, University of Reading

Memberships & Affiliations

2025 – present **Associate Member**, The British Neuropsychological Society

Member, Society for Neuroeconomics

Member, European Society for Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience

2024 – present **LLM HPC Research Group**, University of Birmingham

ReproducibiliTea Board Member, University of Birmingham

Board Member, Club Alpbach London

2024 – 2025 **Student Representative**, British Association for Cognitive Science

2023 – present **R User Group**, University of Birmingham

PUBLICATIONS

Journal papers

Sohail A, Magda A, Said M, Phillips L, Lu Y, Reynolds G, Comer-Fenn A, Russell J, Lu H, Sims T, Saulin AC & Zhang L (**2026**). Transdiagnostic factors differentially shape choices and reaction times in social evaluative learning. *Psychological Medicine*, doi: 10.1017/S0033291726106217

Lin Z & **Sohail A** (**2026**). Recalibrating academic expertise in the age of generative AI. *Patterns*, 7(1), doi: 10.1016/j.patter.2025.101473

Sohail A & Zhang L (**2025**). Using large language models to facilitate academic work in the psychological sciences. *Current Psychology*, 44(9): 7910-7918, doi: 10.1007/s12144-025-07438-2

Sohail A, Pancharatnam RA & Kapsetaki ME (**2025**). Going With the Flow: Achieving Peak Performance in Surgery. *Journal of Surgical Education*, 82(9): 103593, doi: 10.1016/j.jsurg.2025.103593

Rossetti GMK, Dunster JL, **Sohail A**, Williams B, Cox KM, Jewett E, Benford E, Lovegrove JA, Gibbins JM & Christakou A (**2025**). Evidence for direct control of neurovascular function by circulating platelets in healthy older adults. *The Journal of Physiology*, doi: 10.1113/JP288405

Sohail A & Zhang L (**2024**). Informing the treatment of social anxiety disorder with computational and neuroimaging data. *Psychoradiology*, kkae010, doi: 10.1093/psyrad/kkae010

Preprints / under review

König-Kersting C, Litovsky Y, Böhm R, Grossmann I, Huber J, Kirchler M & **WoCCAP Consortium** (**2026**). A many-designs study of 516 algorithms challenges the predictability of wisdom of the crowd forecast aggregation. No. 2026-05

Sohail A, Zhong X, Konovalov A, Lockwood PL & Zhang L (**2026**). Assessing mentalization in humans and large language models. *arXiv preprint*, arXiv:2608.26291

Zhang L & **Sohail A** (**2025**). BayesCog: A freely available course in Bayesian statistics and hierarchical Bayesian modeling for psychological science. *OSF*, doi: 10.31234/osf.io/ua5ng_v1

Sohail A, Saulin AC, Karataş KF, Zhang R & Zhang L (**2025**). Creating an engaging psychology-themed university placement for school students. *OSF*, osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/4mcga_v1

Sohail A (**2025**). Kierkegaardian anxiety in modern psychological research. *OSF*, doi: 10.31234/osf.io/dy92q_v1

Conference posters

Sohail A, Lockwood PL & Zhang L (**2026**). A transdiagnostic account of social influence in group-level decision-making. *Society for Neuroeconomics*, Pasadena, California, US.

Rossetti GMK, Dunster JL, **Sohail A**, Williams B, Cox KM, Jewett E, Benford E, Lovegrove JA, Gibbins JM & Christakou A (**2022**). Preliminary findings from the HAVEN Study: Investigating Haemostatic function, vessel health and neurocognitive health. *Interpreting BOLD III*, Oxford, UK.

Rossetti GMK, **Sohail A**, Bell T & Christakou A (**2021**). Differential haemodynamics responses in the human striatum during initial and reversal learning. *Interpreting BOLD*, Online. Available here.

Williams B, Lee O, Vanags P, **Sohail A**, Brady D, FitzGibbon L & Christakou A (**2021**). Test-retest reliability of model parameter estimates in human reinforcement learning. *Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science*, Online.

Sohail A, Myers JFM, Mick I, Clark L, Bowden-Jones HM, Nutt DJ, Lingford-Hughes AR & Turton SP (**2016**). Analysis of the reward system in Disordered Gamblers using MR and ^{11}C-carfentanil PET. *British Association for Psychopharmacology Summer Meeting*, Brighton, UK.

SKILLS

Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, bash, stan, LaTeX, HTML, JavaScript
Neuroimaging	FSL, SPM12, CONN, mricro, Trained MRI Operator (SIEMENS 3T PRISMA)
Research / Organisation	REDCap, SONA, Gorilla, Prolific, Pavlovia, Qualtrics, git/GitHub/GitLab, oTree, Heroku

REFERENCES

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School of Psychology
University of Birmingham
l.zhang.13@bham.ac.uk

Professor Patricia L. Lockwood
Professor of Decision Neuroscience
School of Psychology
University of Birmingham
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